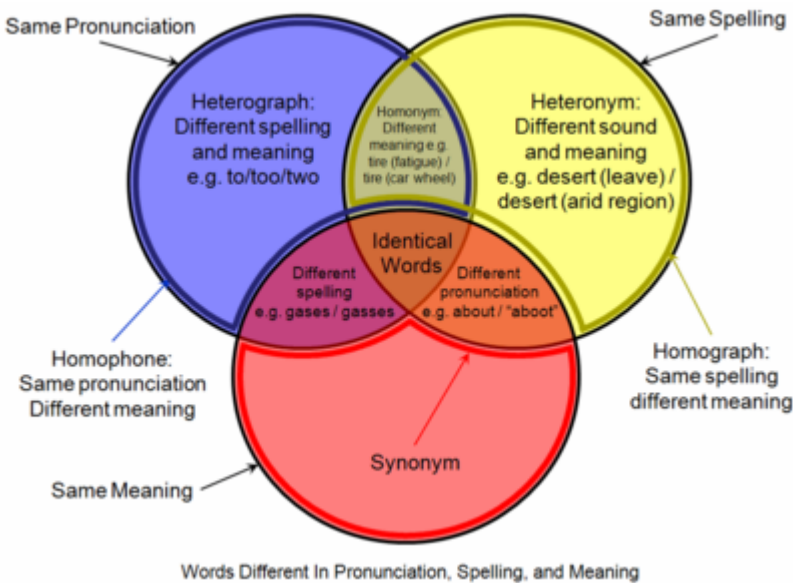


Homograph

A **homograph** (from the Greek: ὁμός, *homós*, "same" and γράφω, *gráphō*, "write") is a word that shares the same written form as another word but has a different meaning.^[1] However, some dictionaries insist that the words must also sound different,^[2] while the Oxford English Dictionary says that the words should also be of "different origin".^[3] In this vein, *The Oxford Guide to Practical Lexicography* lists various types of homographs, including those in which the words are discriminated by being in a different *word class*, such as *hit*, the verb *to strike*, and *hit* the noun *a blow*.^[4]

If, when spoken, the meanings may be distinguished by different pronunciations, the words are also heteronyms. Words with the same writing *and* pronunciation (i.e. are both homographs and homophones) are considered homonyms. However, in a looser sense the term "homonym" may be applied to words with the same writing *or* pronunciation. Homograph disambiguation is critically important in speech synthesis, natural language processing and other fields. Identically written different senses of what is judged to be fundamentally the *same* word are called polysemes; for example, *wood* (substance) and *wood* (area covered with trees).



Venn diagram showing the relationships between homographs (yellow) and related linguistic concepts

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In English

Examples:

- sow (verb) – to plant seed